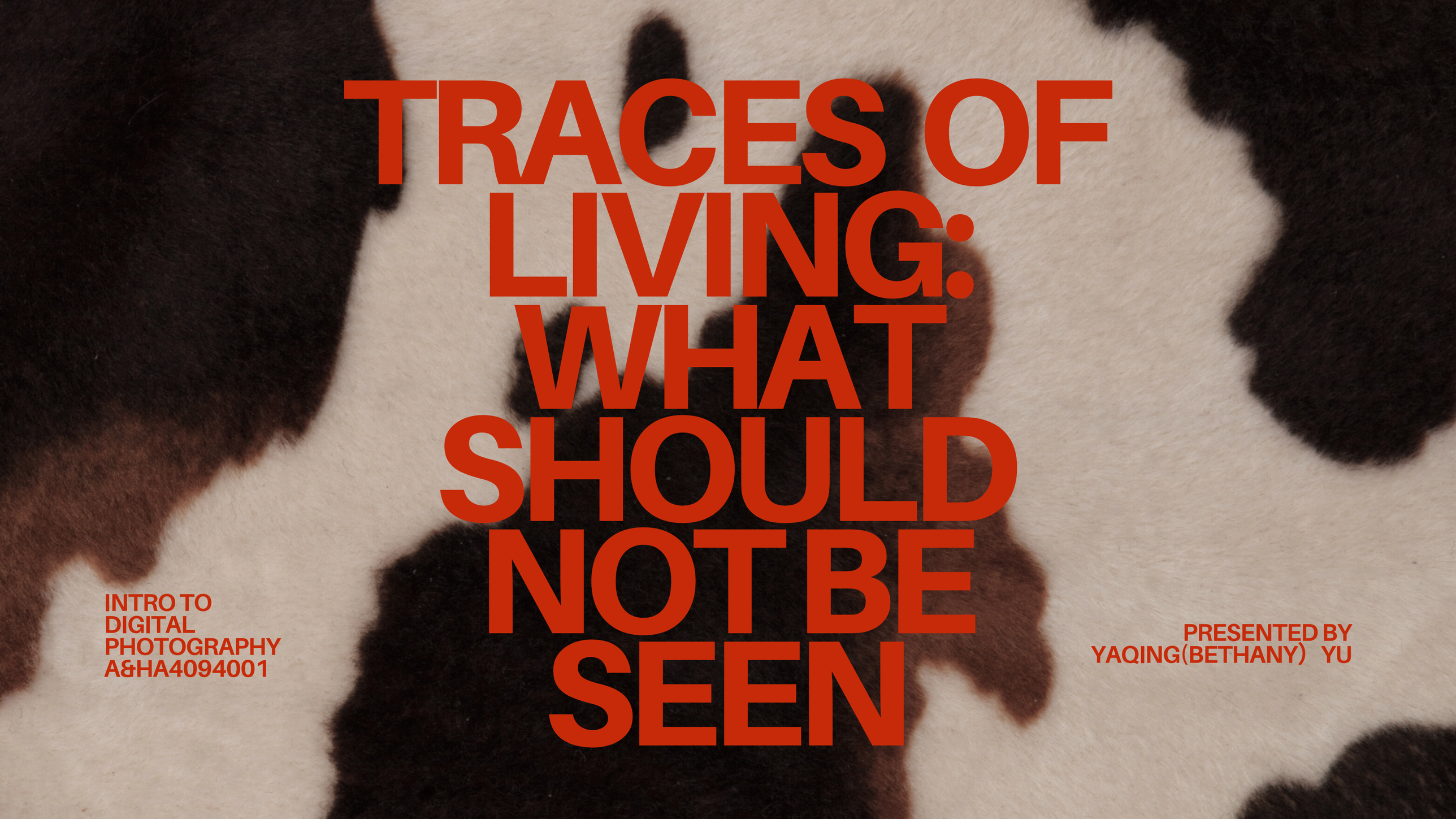


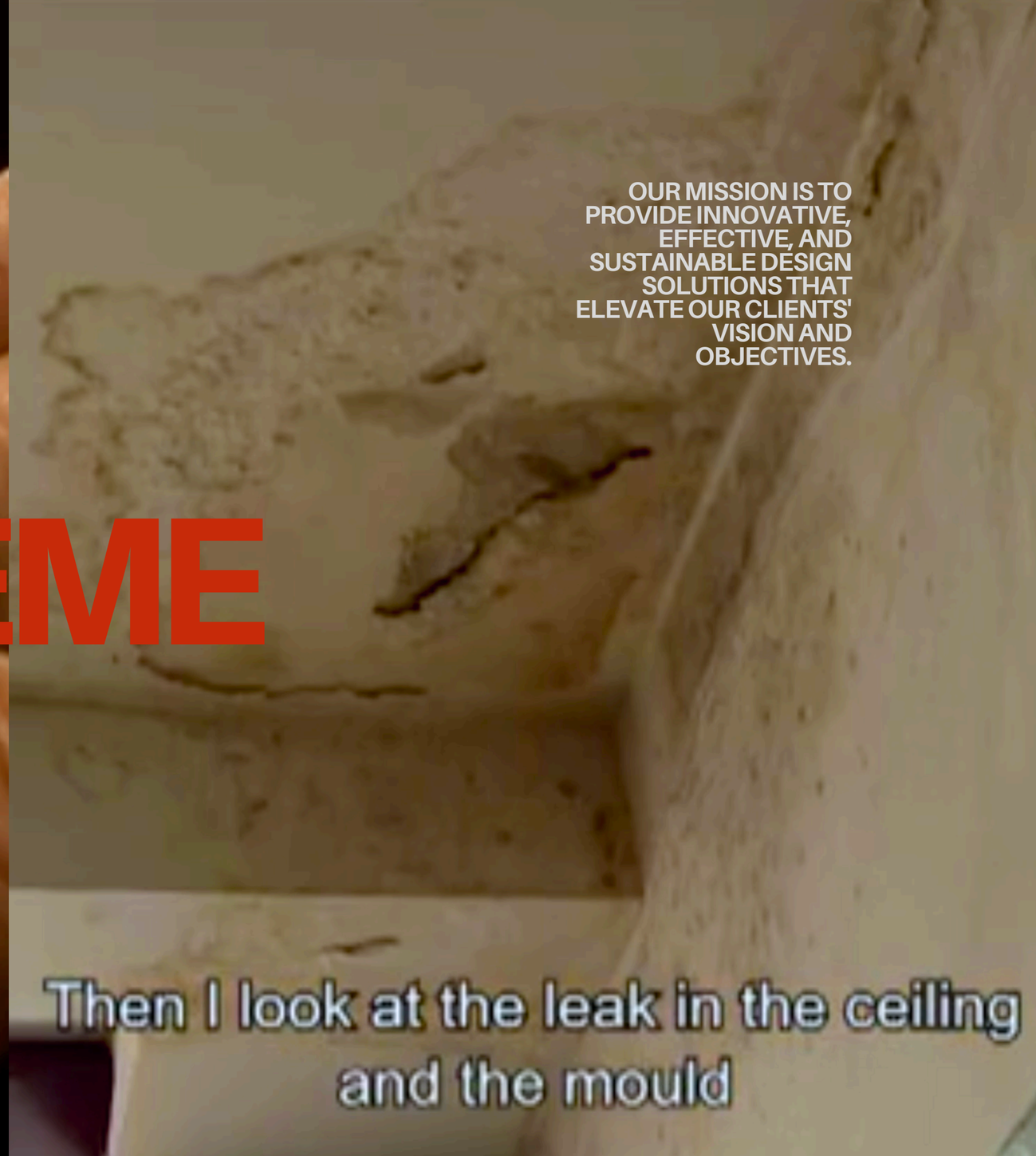
# TRACES OF LIVING: WHAT SHOULD NOT BE SEEN

INTRO TO
DIGITAL
PHOTOGRAPHY
A&HA4094001

PRESENTED BY
YAQING(BETHANY) YU

# THEME

OUR MISSION IS TO PROVIDE INNOVATIVE, EFFECTIVE, AND SUSTAINABLE DESIGN SOLUTIONS THAT ELEVATE OUR CLIENTS' VISION AND OBJECTIVES.



# THEME: TRACES OF LIVING

- Everyday traces often seen as unpresentable
- Not mess, but evidence of life, labor, time, and memory
- Inspired by Agnès Varda's *The Gleaners and I*
- Rooted in my high school dorm experience of regulated cleanliness
- Key question: What is worth seeing?

# GROUP1: DOMESTIC TRACES AND STATES

- Dust + fallen hair
- Traces from air and body
- Usually erased
- Cool / warm contrast
- Abstract lines and textures
- Everyday art of living

# ACCUMULATION OF PRESENCE

# A WALL DRAWING BY TIME

- Cracks on the wall
- Marks naturally formed over time
- Diagonal line guides the viewer’s eye
- Light and shadow reveal the surface
- Not just damage
- An abstract drawing left by time

# STILL LIFE AFTER CONSUMPTION

- Paper and plastic bags after takeout
- Usually seen as disposable, oily, or trash
- Sunlight from the upper left
- Like still-life objects under a spotlight
- Soft side light creates a quiet, romantic feeling
- Reminds me of a takeout bag installation at MoMA

MARGARET E. KNIGHT, CHARLES B. STILWELL FLAT-BOTTOMED PAPER BAG DESIGNED 1870S-1880S

# THE BIN WAS NEVER MEANT TO BE EMPTY

- Dorm rule: trash bin must stay empty
- For me, bin as a contaioner of daily traces
- Challenges excessive cleanliness
- Questions spatial regulation

# THE SHAPE OF REST

- Bed after sleep
- Wrinkles and body impressions
- Not simply mess
- Evidence of bodily presence

# UNFINISHED APPETITE

# VISIBLE ABUNDANCE

# Laundry in Bloom

- Clothes left on the drying rack
- Not clutter, but an easier arrangement
- Detergent scent spreading through the room
- Clothes imagined as fragrant flowers
- Slow shutter + wrist rotation = Swirling, blooming effect

# GROUP 2: THE WEATHERED CITY

# SEDIMENT OF LIVING

- Sloped street in Chinatown
- Diagonal light and shadow
- Sense of movement
- Oil stains and worn surfaces--Soft, vintage beauty

# A STREET BETWEEN ERAS

- Dusty glass of an old storefront
- Rainwater washes away dust
- Stains and flowing lines remain
- Layered shooting through glass

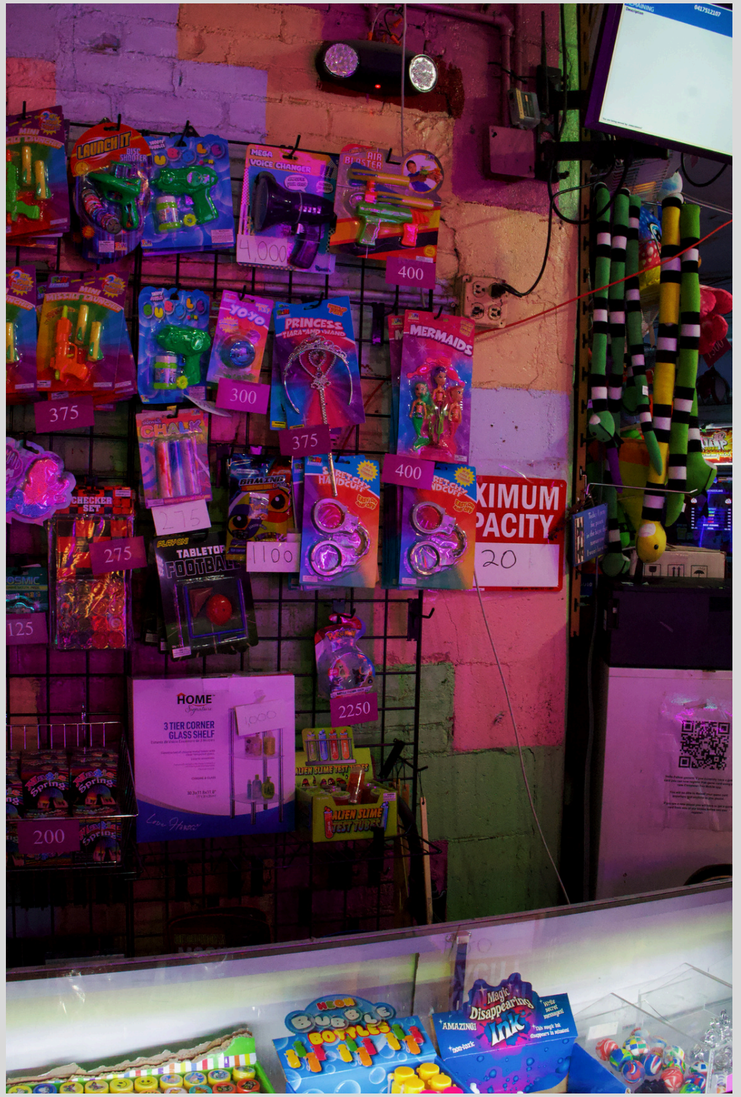
# WEATHER ON GLASS

- Back kitchen of a Cantonese restaurant
- High-angle perspective
- Hidden space seen by chance
- Bright storefront vs. dark kitchen passage
- Leading lines guide the eye to the cook
- Making hidden labor visible and recognized

# KITCHEN, UNVEILED

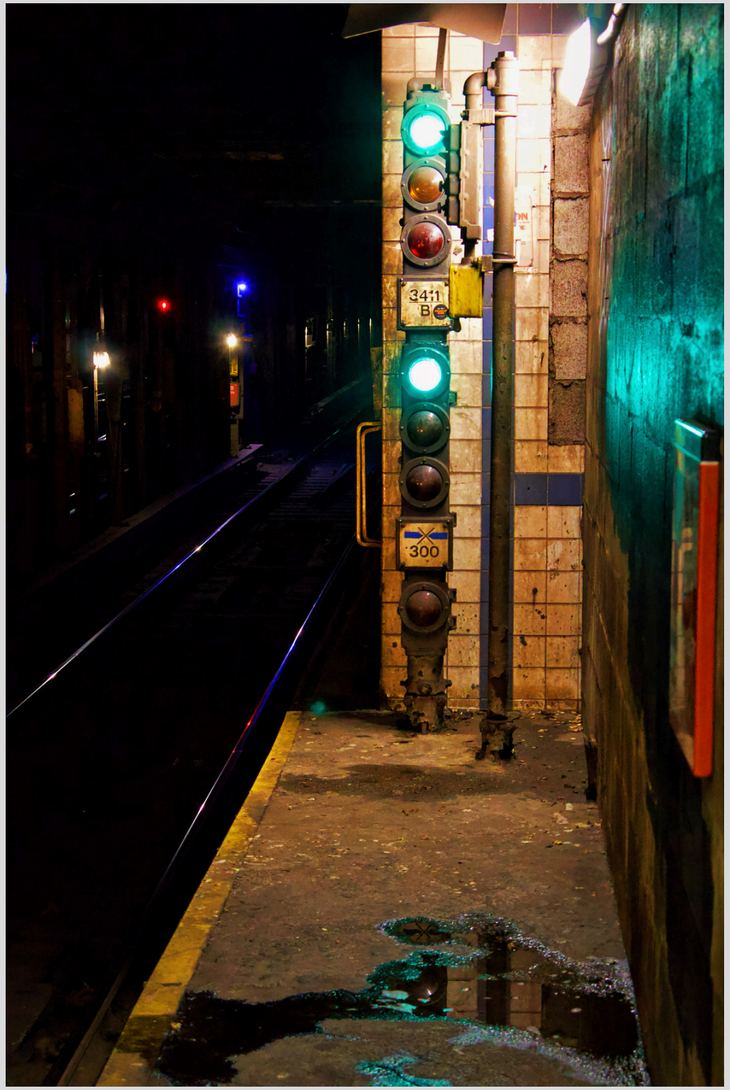
# ARCADE ELEGY

- Old Chinatown arcade
- Handwritten tags + outdated toys
- Worn walls, old machines
- Pink-purple neon light
- Retro and nostalgic mood
- Playful space worth seeing



- Abandoned and partially dismantled bicycle
- Usually seen as street obstacle or waste
- Parts taken apart for reuse
- Still carries material value

# DISASSEMBLY STUDY




- 96th Street subway station
- Waiting, movement, memory
- Warmer side of the subway
- Warm tone + symmetry
- Signal light as focus
- Reflection adds depth

# WARMTH IN TRANSIT

# THE INTERVAL BEFORE REUSE

# THE SCENT OF IRON

# WHAT THE FLOOD LEFT BEHIND

# EVIDENCE OF GROWTH

- Old Cantonese-run barbershop
- Wider composition: chair, mirror, tools, cables
- Busy and authentic everyday state
- Mirror reflection adds spatial layers
- Hair as bodily growth

# THE UNSEEN WORKSITE

- Temporary worksite near 42nd Street
- Rough, simple, easily overlooked space
- Small window as entrance to hidden space
- Sense of voyeuristic looking–Making overlooked labor space visible

# STILL SPEAKING,
# STILL STANDING

# GROUP 3:
# COLLAGE AS ART

# FRAGMENTS DESERVE THE LIGHT

- Friend’s casual collage works
- From “shallow” to worth seeing
- Printed + cut + placed on mirror
- Temporary exhibition feeling
- Purple fill light
- Everyday fragments as art

# THANKS FOR LISTENING